

A good curriculum on FOSS will help raise awareness levels within the students community too and, in turn, help in the development of the FOSS ecosystem. The government should also play a major role at the adoption and contribution level in order to make India more FOSS-friendly. It should encourage the creation of a supportive ecosystem for the FOSS companies to excel." The good news is state governments like Kerala are making efforts not only to promote FOSS but also drive its adoption.

Aditya Mehta, chief executive officer of WickedLeak, comes up with an interesting angle. The advent of Android (which is open source) as a mobile OS has helped raise the level of awareness about FOSS to some extent, he feels. "Android has emerged as an open source champion and, naturally, people are becoming aware of the benefits of FOSS through this. The next few months will see the advent of more open source mobile operating systems like Tizen and Mozilla Firefox, and this will enhance the chances of the young IT talent pool working in these areas. I also feel that open source is not being promoted in the rural areas. I feel handset manufacturers should work with service providers to roll out cheaper Android devices in the rural areas. Who knows, one day we could have open source developers from remote places?" says Mehta.

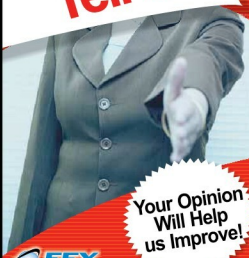
A few open source companies are making an effort to promote FOSS in the country. For example, since 2011, Red

Hat has ramped up activities for the developer community across APAC. With a rapidly growing number of developers coming from India, it has brought several large scale and notable developer events to India. These include FUDCon (Fedora Users and Developers Conference) and JUDCon (JBoss Users and Developers Conference). It also ensures that the latest e-resources, such as webinars, data sheets and videos, are publicly available. These assets are useful to customers, developers and students alike, and can be found on www.redhat.com or via social media channels such as youtube.com/RedHatVideos.

Red Hat also supports schools with a fully Web-deployed and Web-managed program, and outfits them with the technology and technical expertise to start and sustain a Linux curriculum. The Red Hat engineering team works closely with local educational institutions, research bodies and the agencies involved in formulating standards. The engineering team collaborates with various organisations to ensure the proliferation and adoption of Open Standards in every aspect of interaction. 

By Priyanka Sarkar

The author is a member of the editorial team. She loves to weave in and out the little nuances of life and scribble her thoughts and experiences in her personal blog.



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